The Divine Plan — The Doctrine of the Rounds

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fauna, and the highest animal, its crown—man, Change and vary according to the environments and climatic variations, not only with every Round, but every Root-Race likewise, as well as after every geological cataclysm that puts an end to, or produces a turning point in the latter. In the Sixth Root-Race the fossils of the Orang, the Gorilla, and the Chimpanzee will be those of extinct quadrumanous mammals; and new forms—though fewer and ever wider apart as ages pass on and the close of the Manvantara approaches—will develop from the ‘ cast off’ types of the human races as they revert once again to astral, out of the mire of physical, life. There were none before man, and they will be extiinct before the Seventh Race develops. ...

“This will take place, of course, millions of years hence.” (II, 262-3 *) The human state is an essential stage on the ascent of the hierarchical Ladder of Life. Its successful consummation enables the Monad to cone tinue its spiralling journey into superior realms of Being. Each stage marks the unfoldment of the Divine Plan. * Vol, IIT, p, 265, 6 vol, ed.; IT, 274-5, 3rd ed,

CHAPTER IX

THE DOCTRINE OF THE ROUNDS

As with the Doctrine of the Races, the law pertaining to the Doctrine of the Rounds is that of Eternal Motion. The law manifests on such a vast scale, however, that the time periods involved are of cosmic sweep, dwarfing all figures dealing with human events. The subject is of such magnitude that a detailed presentation can hardly be attempted. It can only be handled by means of a general outline, similar to the method that an artist uses when commencing to paint a picture: broad sweeps are made placing distinctive features on the canvas with no consideration given to details. Since a sequential account of the Rounds cannot be presented (for the simple reason that this has not been given), the decision was made to treat the subject by means of seven sections, listing them as follows:

1. Inner Rounds

The Relation of Rounds and Races

The Relation of Rounds and Spheres

The Relation of Rounds and Watchers

The Relation of Rounds and the After-Death States

The Relation of Rounds and Principles

7, Outer Rounds These are but aspects of the Doctrine of the Rounds, subdivided in this manner simply for purposes of description. From the list it is quite apparent that the subject of the Rounds is closely connected and interrelated with the Doctrine of the Spheres and the Doctrine of the Races, therefore some repetition may be noticed. This is unavoidable because of the complex nature of the subject. Take, for example, one of the main postulates:

Everything in the metaphysical as in the physical Universe

is septenary. Hence every sidereal body, every planet, whether visible or invisible, is credited with six companion globes. The evolution of life proceeds on these seven globes or bodies from the Ist to the 7th in Rowunps or Seven Cycles." (I, 158-9 *) Since the Doctrine of the Spheres and the Doctrine of the Races have already been covered, that of the Rounds may be commenced by clarifying the term. * Vol. I, p. 213, 6 vol, ed.; I, 182, 3rd ed.

A Round signifies the circling of a Monad from the first globe of a Chain of globes to the last sphere of the chain, performing seven cycles on each globe. These seven cycles are equivalent to the Seven Root-Races (outlined in the Doctrine of the Races). The seven manifested globes of a Chain are enumerated with the first seven letters of the alphabet: Globe A, Globe B, Globe C, Globe D, Globe E, Globe F, Globe G. Seven Rounds or Seven Circuits of the septenary Chain of Globes are required to complete the Circle of Necessity comprising one Planetary Manvantara (or one planetary period of activity), The significance of the term **Monad"' should be repeated. The word is applied to the immortal essence, the Pilgrim, which is undergoing the cyclic journey, termed the Circle of Necessity. In order to accomplish this journey, the Pilgrim dons a sheath or a vesture which is appropriate to the Kingdom of the Ladder of Life in which it manifests for a planetary period of activity (a planetary manvantara). The Ladder of Life is composed of ten rungs. On each rung of the Ladder is stationed one of the Kingdoms of Life, composed of Hosts or Classes of Monads. For instance, a Monad accomplishing the cyclic journey in the Mineral Kingdom—which represents the fourth rung on the Ladder of Life, or the lowest of the manifested kingdoms—accomplishes one Round when it has performed the circuit of the seven globes of the chain (Globe A to G sequentially).

In the case of a human being, the Monad, the Pilgrim, is at present utilizing a sheath or vesture appropriate to the Human Kingdom for temporary manifestations. It appears on earth in a human body, a physical vehicle, for the period of a lifetime. The Pilgrim leaves the globe for a while, but returns to earth for another lifetime—and then another; ever travelling on the cyclic journey. The present station on the cyclic journey which

the Human Monadic Host is making is the fourth lobe (Globe D) of the septenary chain. As explained in the Doctrine of the Races, the evolutionary development upon a globe is accomplished by means of seven major developmental stages, termed Root-Races, The fifth major developmental stage is in progress, therefore mankind is in the Fifth Root-Race, on the fourth globe.

The execution of seven major developmental stages, or seven RootRaces, on one globe completes one Globe Round. Upon completion of one Globe Round the human Monadic Host moves on to the next station on its cyclic journey, that is, to the next globe of the series of seven, in order to accomplish seven major developmental stages in an advanced degree on that globe, which globe is also superior in degree. The next globe on the cyclic journey is Globe E. Following seven evolutionary steps or slages on Globe E, the Monadic Host will move on to Globe F. After seven developmental stages on Globe F the Human Life-Wave will transfer to Globe G, in order to complete the circuit. When seven Ropt-Races have been completed on cach one of the Seven Globes of the

—one complete Planetary Round has been achieved.

The Human Monadic Host is in process of performing its Fourth Circuit on its cyclic journey, so that it is on its Fourth Planetary Round of the Circle of Necessity. The journey on the Descending Arc (consisting of Globes A, B and C) has been completed, for seven developmental stages have been performed on each of the first three globes. The fourth globe, Globe D, represents the bottom of the arc and also the turning point commencing the Are of Ascent. The Fourth Planetary Round will be concluded when the Monadic Host ‘will have performed seven major developmental stages (or Seven

Root-Races) on each of the globes of the Ascending Arc (Globes E, F, and G),.

The Circle of Necessity will be consummated when seven complete circuits will have been accomplished on all the globes of the chain, that is, Seven Planetary Rounds, each Round consisting of Seven Root-Races on Seven Globes of the Chain. This constitutes the completion of a Day of Brahma, which is the equivalent of one Planetary Manvantara (one planetary period of activity), or one revolution of the Wheel (to use the (term of the Stanzas of Dzyan).

While the term " Round " describes the cyclic character of the evolutional pilgrimage that is being executed, it should also be borne in mind that during each Round a different cyclical stage of evolution, or an advanced degree of development, is being accomplished.

Round repeats on 2 higher scale the evolutionary work of

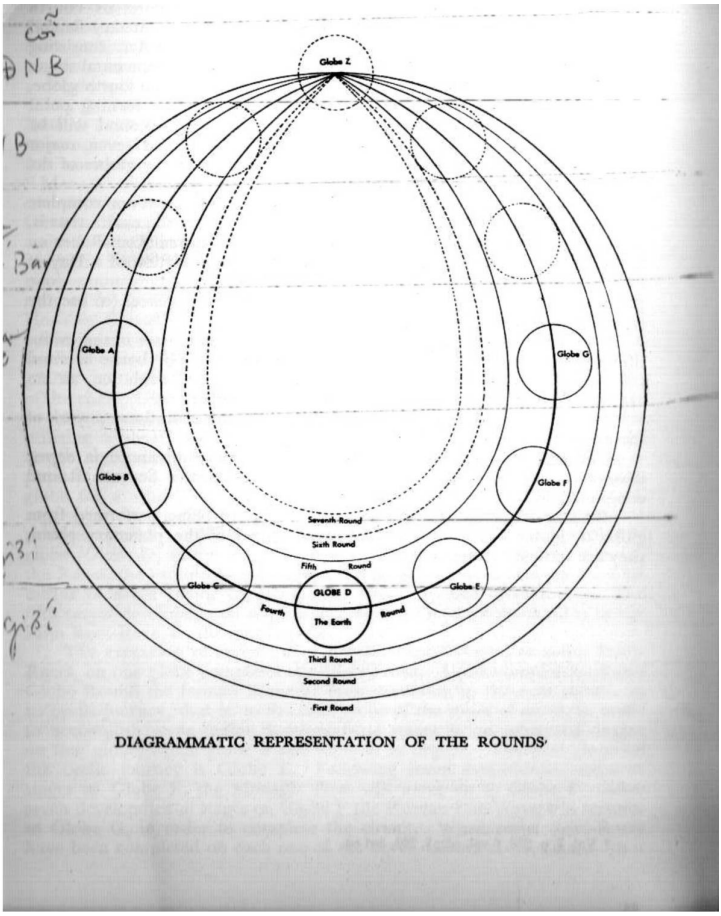
the preceding Round." (I, 187 *)

For even the First Round on a Chain is more advanced in degree, inasmuch as it is on a higher plane, than the former Seventh Round completed on the previous Chain.

Because these cyclical evolutionary stages are being performed from globe to globe within the series of seven globes of the planetary chain, they are termed " Inner Rounds"'.

* Vol. I, p. 238, 6 vol. ed.; 1, 209, 3rd ed.

DIAGRAMMATIC REPRESENTATION OF THE ROUNDS:



DIAGRAMMATIC REPRESENTATION OF THE ROUNDS

that the Seven Rounds are undertaken Dy all the of that 1s, by each one of the ten Classes of Monads or Kingdoms comprising the Ladder of Life. Each Class accomplishes each and every one of the Seven Rounds. To be sure, each Class or Kingdom experiences the circuit in a manner suitable to its own class, that is to say, the Monads utilize vestures and experience an

evolutionary development appropriate to each Kingdom.

In order not to confuse the mind with too many aspects in one diagram, the Seven Cosmic Planes are not depicted, although they may be very easily supplied simply by allocating the topmost globe (named Globe Z) to the First Cosmic Plane, and the bottom globe (Globe D) to Cosmic Plane Seven, and then placing two globes on each of the five remaining Cosmic Planes (regardless of the manner in which the globes are positioned).

In The Secret Doctrine the First Round is described as commencing on Globe A, and continuing through the circuit of the remaining six globes in sequential manner. The reason for this is because both Globe A and Globe G (the seventh manifested globe) are situated on the first manifested plane (which is the Fourth Cosmic Plane—see S.D. I, 200 *). However, there are three planes superior to the planes of manifestation, which may be termed the planes of the ‘‘ Unmanifested * (for convenience and clarity), on which are stationed the Ariipa-lokas (literally the ‘‘‘ No-form Worlds

to be drawn to the Fourth Round, it is therefore emphasized by means of the heaviest line. It is the Round that is now being accomplished and the Arc of Descent has brought the Human Life-Wave to Globe D (our Earth). Furthermore, the heavy line also indicates that it is the most material of the Rounds, or in other words, matter is predominant on the Fourth Round. It should also be remembered that a Globe Round is accom-

by means of the development of Seven Races on one Globe—the

even Races being equivalent to seven stages of development or advances in evolution; whereas a Planetary Round signifies the accomplishment of Seven Races on each one of the globes of the complete circuit.

In recapitulation: the Human Life-Wave is undergoing its Fourth Round upon the Fourth Globe (of the seven manifested or Riipa-lokas), and it has reached its fifth developmental stage. It is therefore stated to be in the Fifth Race.

As there are some pioneers in the forefront of human evolution who are undergoing their Fifth Planetary Cycle, the Fifth Round 4s indicated by means of an elliptical orbit, yet it takes place within the field of activity of the Fourth Round. In other words, the Fifth Round is also being accomplished in and on and through the series of all the globes of the

The Sixth Round and the Seventh Round are indicated by means of dotted lines, conveying the idea that these Rounds will be undertaken in the far-flung aeons of the future. These Rounds in their tum will be accomplished in and on and through all the globes of the chain.

2. THE RELATION OF ROUNDS AND RACES

The use of the word “‘ in the title of this section is intended to include all the beings composing the Ten Classes of Monads, or Kingdoms, on the Ladder of Life. Each one of the ten classes is pursuing its evolutionary cycles on the globes of the planetary chain by means of the Rounds. ‘The reason for the use of the term is that all classes of monads must perform seven major developmental stages on each globe of the chain, irrespective of their status on the evolutionary Ladder of Life—that is irrespective of the Kingdom in which they are at present undergoing their evolutionary experiences. In the following citation, outlining the circuit, the evolutionary cycle is illustrated. by reference to the Human Kingdom; the opening words “the grand cycle” signify one Globe Round; the concluding words “‘ seven minor or the great ‘‘ Racial Cycles” stand for the seven Root-Races:

Grand Cycle includes the progress of mankind from the

appearance of primordial man of ethereal form. It runs through

the inner cycles of his (mens) progressive evolution from the ethereal

down to the semi-cthereal and purely physical: down to the

continues running its course Gownward and then upward again,

to meet at the culmination of a Round, when the manvantaric

‘Serpent swallows its tail’ and seven minor cycles are passed.

These are the great Racial Cycles." (I, 642 *) The manvantaric serpent swallowing its tail represents one period of activity and the completion of one Round; also symbolizing the Descending Arc and the Ascending Arc.

Such is a general description of what occurs during the period of one Round, although especially applicable to our present Round—ihe Fourth Round, as being the most material of the Rounds. It should be borne in mind, however, that each Round has its specific evolutionary status to be carried out. In the same way each globe has its distinctive condition to be accomplished.

Of especial significance is the process that commences evolution on the first globe, Globe A, and on the First Round, representing the awakening of a Chain from its laya condition (a state where matter and spirit are homogeneous; complete rest). First to appear on the central core of the globe-to-be, ahead even of the lowest kingdom stationed on the tenth rung of the Ladder of Life—named the Third Elemental Kingdom—are the classes of the Dhyani-Chohanic Kingdoms which were not able to graduate from the Chain which had entered Pralaya (the period of complete rest— dissolution). Because of this " failure'? they act as guardians or leaders of the Chain-to-be, which is a reimbodiment of the former Chain. These Classes remain in the spiritual realms, so to speak, of the first globe (Globe A) during this process of formation, although not entering into the material aspect of the globe. By thus remaining as a spiritual force, they provide the patterns or types for all the lower Kingdoms on the Ladder of Life, without actually entering into the evolutionary processes of these Classes, until the Seventh Class arrives. The Seventh Class is the Human Kingdom.

When the Third Elemental Kingdom has performed its seven developmental stages—part of which consists in the formative process of the globe itself, albeit invisible to the physical eye—the majority of the hosts of these elemental beings leave the first globe, just as the leaders have done, entering the core of the second globe, in order to perform seven cycles on Globe B, as well as to aid in the building of the second sphere. In the previous section, the Doctrine of the Races, these seven cycles were compared to seven waves of effort which surge on from one globe to the next, carrying the life impulse to the next globe.

Reference was made to the majority of the host of beings passing from a globe in order to carry the life impulse to a new globe. However, a minority is left behind upon the first globe, as well as subsequently upon each one of the globes as each Class of the Monadic Hosts advances from

* Vol. II, p. 367, 6 vol. ed.; I, 703-4, 3rd ed.

'They are technically termed word literally meaning ~ remain~ders," since the majority of their Class has moved on to another sphere. The purpose of the Sishtas is to remain on the globe providing future * seeds of life " to the Monadic Host when it returns to that sphere on subsequent Rounds. Thus the highest and most evolved type achieved by means of the seven developmental stages carried out upon the globe is preserved. The Sishtas maintain the "remainder forms" intact, during the absence of the Life-Wave which carries the host of monads around the

of the Chain, awaiting the time-period when the returning LifeWave will bring the life impulse to that sphere, and revivify the activities pertaining to the specific kingdom to

which the Sishtas belong.

It should be borne in mind that every one of the Ten Classes of Monads, or Kingdoms, leaves its own Sishtas on each one of the seven globes of a Chain each time that that Kingdom pursues its seven evolutionary developmental stages on each sphere during each Round. In this way the returning Life-Wave need not “ rebuild” a new form, but simply takes up the evolutionary stage at which it was dropped in the previous cycle.

Disposing of the query that arises in regard to the “ sacrifice”. that the Sishtas make—with especial reference to the Human Kingdom. While in a way it is akin to a sacrifice to be left behind by the surging evolutionary stream of life, nevertheless compensations may be noted: (1) the Sishtas are in a quasi-Nirvanic condition and are not caught up in the evolutionary Whirl of activities; (2) consequently they are not creating “ new karma”; 3) the Sishtas are under the direct guardianship and watched over by the uperior Kingdoms on the Ladder of Life, which have their evolutionary cycles during the absence of the seven lower kingdoms to which the Sishtas belong.

Returning to the entrance of the Classes of Monads at the commencement of a Chain. As the life impulse of the Third Elemental Kingdom surges on to Globe B, leaving its Sishtas on Globe A, the host of Monads comprising the Second Elemental Kingdom, awakening from their pralayic rest, enter the first globe in order to accomplish their seven developmental stages on Globe A. When the Third Elemental Kingdom has completed its seven waves of effort on Globe B, and surges on to carry the life impulse to the third globe, the Second Elemental Kingdom likewise has completed its seven waves of effort on Globe A and moves on to Globe B, leaving its ishtas and making room

for the host of monads comprising the First Elemental Kingdom to enter Globe A. Then the class of monads forming the Third Elemental Kingdom achieve seven developmental stages on Globe C, depart from the third globe after leaving their Sishtas and carry the life impulse to Globe D; the Second Elemental Kingdom surges on to Globe C; the First Elemental Kingdom travels to Globe B; and the first of the manifested kingdoms, consisting of the host of monads in the

Kingdom situated on the fourth rung of the Ladder of Life,

Globe A,

** The three evolutions completed: palpable globe begins to form,

The mineral kingdom fourth in the whole series, but first in this

stage [of manifested kingdoms] leads the way. Its deposits are at

first vaporous, soft and plastic, only becoming hard and concrete in the

seventh * —or seventh evolutionary development on Globe A. With the completion of its seven stages of unfoldment the Mineral Life-Wave transfers its energies to Globe B, leaving its Sishtas on the first globe, while the class of monads pertaining to the Plant Kingdom enter Globe A. Meanwhile the First Elemental Kingdom moves from the second globe to Globe C; the Second Elemental Kingdom pursues its way to Globe D; and the Third Elemental Kingdom commences the Ascending Arc by rising to Globe E. The Descending Arc consists of the passage

from Globes A to D, the Ascending Arc comprises the circuit of Globes D to G. As soon as the monads of the Plant Kingdom have achieved their seven developmental stages on Globe A, the host of monads carries the life impulse to Globe B after leaving its Sishtas on the first globe. Then it becomes the turn of the monads using the vehicles of the Animal Kingdom to enter Globe A. In orderly sequence, the Mineral Kingdom moves on to Globe C; the First Elemental Kingdom descends to Globe D; the Second Elemental Kingdom commences its ascent by mounting to Globe E; and the Third Elemental Kingdom rises to Globe F. When the class of monads comprising the Animal Kingdom has accomplished its seven developmental stages on Globe A, the monadic host leaves its Sishtas on the first globe in order to commence its evolutionary phases on Globe B, and the seventh class on the Ladder of Life enters Globe A. This is the human host of monads, emerging from the inter-planetary pralayic period. The rhythmic circuit continues with the advent of the monads of the Animal Kingdom to Globe B; the Plant Kingdom transfers its vital energies to Globe C; the Mineral Kingdom descends to Globe D; the First Elemental Kingdom ascends to Globe E; the Second Elemental Kingdom mounts to Globe F; the Third Elemental Kingdom rises to Globe G.

With the coming of the Human Life-Wave to Globe A (on the First Round) the Dhyani-Chohanic Classes which had preceded all the lower kingdoms arise from their inactive state and commence to function,

**Then they become an active Force, and commingle with the

Elementals, or progressed entities of the pure animal kingdom to

develop little by little the full type of humanity. In this commingling they lose their high intelligence and spirituality of Devaship to regain them in the end of the seventh ring in the seventh round." +

* The Mahatma Letters to A. P. Sinnett, p. 94.

t Mbid., p. 87.

compact being he is destined to become on our earth. Evolving seven parent races with many offshoots of sub-races, he, like the preceding kingdoms completes his seven rings and is then transferred successively to each of the globes onward to Z. From the first man has all the seven principles included in him in germ but none are developed. .. . In each of the rounds he makes one of the principles develop fully." * It should be borne in mind that the evolutionary process for the host of monads pertaining to the Human Kingdom during the First Round differs from that which occurs in the following Rounds. Observe the following:

** Man, or rather that which becomes man, passes through all the forms and kingdoms during the first Round and through all the human shapes during the two following Rounds.'" (I, 159-f) However, the monads pertaining to the Human Kingdom even during the First Round (and especially so during the following Rounds) are not of the same degree, evolutionally speaking, in fact:

**The Monadic Host may be roughly divided into three: great classes:

**1. The most developed Monads (the Lunar Gods or ' Spirits,' called, in India, the Pitris), whose furiction it is to pass in the-

first Round through the whole triple cycle of the mineral, vegetable, and animal kingdoms in their most ethereal, filmy, and rudimentary forms, in order to clothe themselves in, and assimilate, the nature of the newly formed chain. They are those who first reach the human form (if there can be any form in the realm of the almost subjective) on Globe A in the first Round. It is they, therefore, who lead and represent the human element during the second and third Rounds, and finally evolve their shadows at the beginning of the oom Round for the second class, or those who come behind

**2. Those Monads that are the first to reach the human stage during the three and a half Rounds, and to become men.

**3. The laggards; the Monads which are retarded, and which will not reach, by reason of Karmic impediments, the human stage at all during this cycle or Round." (I, 174-5 f) The assertion that man has evolved through the patterns or types of the three lower kingdoms—although not in physical form or substance, since the first globe in the First Round is not a material globe and does * Op. cit., pp. 94-5. In regard to the of agreed to call the pamage of a monad frum globe A5 1 4 2 1 12 853 1864 23 91 81.052582 to5 1 4 2 1 13 898 1864 77 91 91.615486 globe5 1 4 2 1 14 993 1872 59 59 36.765930 *2Z {or op. cit, p80 t Vol. I, p. 214, 6 vol. ed.; I, 183, 3rd ed. t Vol. I, p. 227, 6 vol. ed.; I, 197, 3rd ed.

the process which the human foetus still passes through in its intra-uterine life. This is clearly indicated in a Commentary upon the Stanzas of Dzyan:

**The human foetus follows now in its transformations all the

forms that the physical frame of man had assumed throughout the

three Kalpas (Rounds) during the tentative efforts at plastic forma-

tion around the monad by senseless, because imperfect, matter, in

her blind wanderings. In the present age, the physical embryo is

a plant, a reptile, an animal, before it finally becomes man, evolving

within himself his own ethereal counterpart, in his (I, 184 *)

_ To be sure, the process that has been described applies to what man now undergoes and thus has reference to man in the present, Fourth Round, not to man of the First Round. For

**the ‘Man’ on Globe A during the First Round is no Man,

but only his prototype or dimensionless image from the astral

regions.” (I, 175 f)

When the seven classes of monads on the Ladder of Life have completed their seven evolutionary stages on a globe and have left their Sishtas thereon—the seventh class of which is the Human Kingdom—the globe thus left enters into a stage of dormancy. This is often referred to as the inter-Round pralaya, although technically the term pralaya does not describe the condition, since the globe is not “‘ (the literal meaning of the term pralaya). In fact, the representatives of the Life-waves pertaining to the seven classes of monads (the Sishtas) still occupy and maintain the globe, although no longer continue in a state of activity, evolutionally speaking. The term has likewise been applied to the state of the globe, although this word, too, does not convey the meaning of a ““‘ sleeping sphere

in the sense that the lower classes of the Life-waves are not pursuing their evolutionary activities on the globe.

As the Human Kingdom completes its seven developmental.stages on each one of the globes of the Chain in sequence, leaving its Sishtas on each globe, each sphere passes into the state of dormancy. When the Human Life-wave concludes the seventh evolutionary stage on the seventh globe (Globe G) the complete chain of globes rests in a state of dormancy. An inter-Round Nirvana ensues, lasting for an interval equal to one tenth the time-period of the preceding Round-period of activity.

The evolutionary process of the seven classes of monads is so adjusted that by the time the seventh class (the Human) has completed its seventh developmental stage on the last globe of the circuit, all the kingdoms will have finished their evolutionary stages on Globe G at approximately the

* Vol. I, p. 235, 6 vol. ed.; I, 206, 3rd ed.

t Vol. 1, p. 228, 6 vol. ed.; 1, 199, Srd ed.

Retardation, operating as a fulcrum, so to speak, irom the lowest to the highest globe of the series, acting as acceleration on the Descending Arc and retardation on the Ascending Arc. Thus the classes on the lower rungs of the Ladder of Life respond to the Law of Acceleration on the Descending Arc, hastening their cyclic activities. The more highly evolved classes come under the sway of the Law of Acceleration on the superior globes of the Ascending Arc, whereas the less evolved kingdoms respond to the Law of Retardation on the Arc of Ascent.

** When all kingdoms have reached globe Z they will not move forward to re-enter A in precedence of man, but under a law of retardation operative from the central point—or earth—to Z and which equilibrates a principle of acceleration in the descending arc —they will have just finished their respective evolution of genera and species, when man reaches his highest development on globe Z. —in The reason for it is found in the enormously greater time required by them to develop their infinite varieties as. compared with man; the relative speed of development in the rings therefore naturally increases as we go up the scale from the mineral. But these different rates are so adjusted by man stopping Jonger in the inter-planetary spheres of rest, for weal or woe—that all kingdoms finish their work simultaneously on the planet Z." * When the time-period of the inter-Round Nirvana has run its course, Globe A responds to the thrill of life as the incoming monads recommence their evolutionary periods of activity. They follow the same sequence outlined for the First Round. But there is a difference in the Second Round. Since the "remainder-forms" have been preserved by the Sishtas, neither the globe nor the types need to be rebuilt or re-established. The incoming monadic hosts pick up the waiting forms of their respective: kingdoms and commence their new series of seven developmental stages on their Second Circuit, adjusting to the Second Round conditions prevailing for both spheres and monads.

Beginning so early as with the 2nd round, Evolution proceeds already on quite a different plan. It is only during the Ist round that (heavenly) man becomes a human being on globe A (rebecomes) a mineral, an animal, on globe B and C, etc. The process changes entirely from the second round.'" (I, 159-60 f) When the seven classes of monads have performed their

Secondary Circuit of seven developmental stages on each one of the seven globes of the Chain, following the process outlined for the First Round, they will have completed their Second Round, and the second inter-Round Nirvana will ensue. * The Mahatma Letters to A. P. Sinnett, pp. 95-6,: t Vol. I, p. 214, 6 vol. ed.; I, 183, Srd ed.

takes place for the third time, developing [Third Round qualities for the spheres as well as the classes of monads. For, be it noted, each Round on the Descending Arc of the cycle of Rounds becomes more and more material. As outlined in the Doctrine of the Spheres, the fourth globe of the Chain is the most material of the spheres. As further explained in the Doctrine of the Races, the fourth major developmental stage is the most material of the Root-Races. Similarly in the cycle of the Rounds, the Fourth is the most material of the Rounds. Consequently the Third Round is more material than the Second Circuit, and preparatory stages for the Fourth Round become manifest in the Third. Nevertheless it should be remembered that even in the Third Round the most material aspect was not equivalent to matter in the Fourth Round. Thus all evolutionary development

up to the Third Round is formless, as matter, and senseless, as consciousness." (I, 24-7 *)

The centres of consciousness (destined to develop into humanity as we know it) of the third Round arrived at a perception of the third Element, Water." (I, 247 fT) Then, too, it was during the Third Round that man passed through the "' non-rational " stage of existence. (Cf. II, 299 }) As to the progressive stages of man's consciousness:

** In the first round his consciousness on our earth is dull and but feeble and shadowy, something like that of an infant. When he reaches our earth in the second round he has become responsible in a degree, in the third he becomes so entirely. At every stage and every round his development keeps pace, with the globe on which he is.”’ § While considering the Third Round evolutionary stage, it should be pointed out that just as in the Fourth Round all the mammalian animals are regarded as “ off-throwings”’ from the original mammalian type, of which man is the fourth-round representative, so during the Third Round certain types came into being from the third-round type which man then represented.

Third Round terrestrial animal forms were just as much

referable to types thrown off by Third-Round man, as that new importation into our planet’s area—the mammalian stock—is to the Fourth Round Humanity of the Second Root-Race. The process * Vol. I, p. 292, 6 vol. ed.; I, 267, 3rd ed. t Vol. I, p. 297, 6 vol. ed.; I, 273, 3rd ed. t Vol. III, p. 300, 6 vol, ed.; II, 313, 3rd ed. § The Mahatma to A, P. Sinnett, p, 95,

teristics OF the rourtn, Dut Of the inird NKound terrestrial lite. The diapason of type is run through in (II, 68-5 *)

** It is correct to say that the man of this Manvantara, i.e., during the three preceding Rounds, has passed through all the kingdoms of nature. That he was ‘a stone, a plant, an animal’. But (a) these stones, plants, and animals were the prototypes, the filmy presentments of those of the Fourth Round; and (4) even those at the beginning of the Fourth Round were the astral shadows of the present, as the Occultists express it. And

finally the forms and genera of neither man, animal, nor plant were what they became later. Thus the astral prototypes of the lower beings of the animal kingdom of the Fourth Round, which preceded (the of) Men, were the consolidated, though still very ethereal sheaths of the still more ethereal forms or models produced at the close of the Third Round on Globe D. ‘ Produced from the residue of the substance matter; from dead bodies of men and (other extinct) animals of the wheel before,’ or the previous Third Round—as §loka 28 tells us. Hence, while the nondescript ‘ animals’ that preceded the astral man at the beginning of this life-cycle on our Earth were still, so to speak, the progeny of the man of the Third Round, the mammalians of this Round owe their existence, in a great measure, to man again.” (II, 685 f) While these passages are dealing with the physical forms in which the monads manifest as sheaths, so to speak, according to their respective kingdoms, thus showing that man (or rather “ Heavenly Man,” that is Adam Kadmon, as the Kabbala expresses it, meaning the “ ideal type”’) is the repository of all physical forms,’ there is even a more tent reason for this attraction towards or affinity for man, which expressed in the enlightening words of a Commentary upon the Stanzas of Dzyan:

*** Every form on earth, and every speck (atom) in Space strives in its efforts towards self-formation to follow the model placed for it in the “ Heaventy Man’. Its (the atom’s) involution and evolution, its external and internal growth and development, have all one and the same object—man; man, as the highest physical and ultimate form on this earth; the Monap, in its absolute totality and awakened condition—as the culmination of the divine incarnations on Earth.’” (I, 183 Even though stressing the fact that it is the Monad which is using the sheaths or vestures of the Class or Kingdom to which it is

attached * Vol, IV, pp. 254-5, 6 vol, ed.; II, 723, 3rd ed. t Vol. III, p. 193, 6 vol, ed.; IT, 196-7, 3rd ed. t Vol. I, p. 235, 6 vol. ed.; I, 205-6, Srd ed.

exactly what the status of the Monad 1s:

** there is no such thing as a Monad (Jiva) other than divine, and consequently having been, or having to become, human. And the latter term [i.e., Human Monad] has to remain meaningless unless the difference is well understood. The Monad is a drop out of the shoreless Ocean beyond, or, to be correct, within the plane of primeval differentiation. It is divine in its higher and Auman in its lower condition—the adjectives 'higher' and 'lower' being used for lack of better words—and a monad it remains at all times, save in the Nirvanic state, under whatever conditions, or whatever external forms. As the Logos reflects the Universe in the Divine Mind, and the manifested Universe reflects itself in each of its Monads, as Leibnitz put it, repeating an Eastern teaching, so the Monap has, during the cycle of its incarnations, to reflect in itself every root-form of cach kingdom. Therefore, the Kabalists say correctly that ' Man becomes a stone, a plant, an animal, a man, a Spirit, and finally God. Thus accomplishing his cycle or circuit and returning to the point from which he had started as the heavenly Man.' But by 'Man' the divine Monad is meant, and not the thinking Entity, much less his physical body." (II, 185-6 *) After concluding the Third Circuit by performing seven developmental stages on each of the globes of the Ascending Arc (Globes, E, F and G), there occurred the inter-Round Nirvana. All was in readiness for the present Circuit, the Fourth Round.

** Let us recapitulate.

‘*The most developed Monads (the lunar) reach the human germ stage in the first Round; become terrestrial, though very ethereal human beings towards the end of the Third Round, remaining on it (the globe) through the ‘ obscuration’ period as the seed [Sishtas] for future mankind in the Fourth Round, and thus become the pioneers of Humanity at the beginning of this, the Fourth Round. Others reach the Human stage only during later Rounds, 7.e., in the second, third, or first half of the Fourth Round. And finally the most retarded of all, i.¢., those still occupying animal forms after the middle turning-point of the Fourth Round—will not become men at all during this Manvantara, They will reach to the verge of humanity only at the close of the seventh’ Round to be, in their turn, ushered into a new chain after pralaya—by older pioneers, the progenitors of humanity, or the Secd-Humanity (Sishta), viz., the men who will be at the head of all at the end of these Rounds.” (I, 182 ft) * Vol. IIT, p. 192, 6 vol. ed.; II, 196, 3rd ed. + Vol. I, pp, 233-4, 6 vol, ed.; I, 204-5, 3rd ed.

DB, G4) awalung the Monadic Host of the Human Kingdom as

it pursued the cyclic descent on this Fourth Round. Even now the “seeds of life’ for future mankind are ready, waiting on the globes of the Ascending Arc (Globes E, F, G). The account of the Root-Races of humanity, as described in the Doctrine of the Races, gives the story of the cyclic journcy on our globe alone (Globe D), outlining four and a half major developmental stages during the present Fourth Round. Before passing on to the next section, a brief descriptive outline of Man during the Four Rounds is available—a sort of bird’s-cye view:

** Thus, as the teaching stands:

“ Man in the First Round and First Race on Globe D [see Note 1], our Earth, was an cthereal being (a Lunar Dhyani, as man), non-intclligent but super-spiritual; and correspondingly, on the law of analogy, in the First Race of the Fourth Round. ”

Note 1. first ‘ Nature,” the first “ bedy,” the first “mind” on the first plane of perception, on the first Globe in the first Round, is what was meant.’ ”

Round. He (Man) is still gigantic and ethereal but

growing firmcr and more condensed in body, a more physical man. Yet still less intelligent than spiritual, for mind is a slower and more difficult evolution than is the, physical frame.’ ”

Round. He has now a perfectly concrete or compacted

body, at first the form of a giant-ape, and now more intelligent, or rather cunning, than spiritual. For, on the downward arc, he has now reached a point where his primordial spirituality is eclipsed and overshadowed by nascent [see note 2]

Note 2. “““ Restore: he has now reached the point (by analogy, and as the Third Root-Race in the Fourth Round) where his (“the angel ”-man’s) primordial spirituality is eclipsed and overshadowed by nascent human mentality, and you have the true version on your thumb-nail.’ ”

“*In the last half of the Third Round his gigantic stature decreases, and his body improves in texture, and he becomes a more rational being, though still more an ape than a Deva. (All this is almost exactly repeated in the third Root-Race of the

Fourth Round.) ’” “‘TV. Round. Intellect has an enormous development in this Round, The (hitherto) dumb races acquire our (present) human speech on this globe, on which, from the Fourth Race, language is perfected and knowledge increases. At this half-way point of the Fourth Round (as of the Fourth Root, or Atlantean, race) humanity passes the axial point of the minor Manvantara CYGCIS » a0

ual decrease. (4, 100-7

‘© These are the words of the Teacher—text, words and sentences in brackets, and explanatory footnotes.” (I, 189 f) One descriptive note regarding our Earth (Globe D) and Man during the First Round may be added:

‘* As the solid Earth began by being a ball of liquid fire, of fiery dust and its protoplasmic phantom, so did man.” (I, 191 Or, perhaps in the clearer words of a Commentary:

“The globe was ‘ fiery, cool and radiant as its ethereal men and animals during the first Round,’ says the Ccmmentary.” (I, 252 §) By the law of Analogy, during the Seventh Round the globe and man will once again attain this condition.

3. THE RELATION OF ROUNDS AND SPHERES

Just as the preceding section dealt with the status of the Classes of Monads during their cyclic journeys on the spheres of the planetary chain, so the present section will cover the subject of the status of the globes themselves during the passage of the Monadic Hosts through the sevenfold spheres, the completion of one circuit of the globes, from first to last, being termed one Round. The significance of the term “ status of the globes ” may be made plain by referring to the third postulate covering the teaching regarding the spheres. In the citation, Earth” signifies the fourth globe of the Earth Planetary Chain, also called “ Globe D.”

**3. Our Earth, as the visible representative of iis invisible superior fellow globes, its ‘lords’ or ‘ principles,’ has to live, as have the others, through seven Rounds. During the first three, it forms and consolidates; during the fourth it settles and hardens; during the last three it gradually returns to its first ethereal form: it is spiritualized, so to say.” (I, 159 ||) At the outset it would be well to re-state the position of the spheres in their relation to the planes. The seven globes of the planetary chain are located on the four lowest Cosmic Planes in the following manner:

Globes A and G on the Fourth Cosmic Plane

Globes B and F on the Fifth Cosmic Plane

Globes G and E on the Sixth Cosmic Plane

Globe D (alone) on the Seventh Cosmic Plane The cyclic period of a Round is measured by the passage of the Classes of Monads on the spheres, and the descent and ascent through the planes * Vol. I, pp. 239-40, € vol. ed.; I, 211-2, 3rd 3d. Vol. I; pp. 240, 6

vol. ed.; I, 212, Srd ed. Vol. I, 242, 6 vol. ed.; if, 214,

p. 297, 6 vol. ed.; 1, 273, ard ed Vout, 5.218, ed, 183, 3rd ed.

fLosts trom the rourtn to the seventh represents the first half of the Round-cycle and is termed a descent on the Arc of Matter (of the evolution of matter—during which spirit is involved) or the Descending Arc. The monadic Life-Waves thus accomplish one half of the Round-cycle by circling on Globes A, B, C and D. The journey of the Classes of Monads on the latter half of the Round-cycle is made by ascending from the Seventh Cosmic Plane, through the Sixth, the Fifth and back to the Fourth Plane, thus completing one Round. The mounting through the planes is termed an ascent on the Arc of Spirit (or an evolution of spirit, during which matter is involved) of the Ascending Arc. The Monadic Hosts complete the Round-cycle by circling on Globe E, F, and G.

The status of the spheres in relation to the Rounds, that is to say the stages of progressive evolutionary development which the globes follow during the Rounds, comes under the same law which governs the Monadic Hosts, namely, an increase in materiality towards the middle point of the Round-cycle (Rounds 1, 2, 3 and one-half). Then a return to spirituality during the latter half of the Round-cycle (Rounds 4, 5, 6 and 7).

** Now every ‘ Round’ (on the descending scale) is but a repeti-

tion in a more concrete form of the Round which preceded it, as

every globe—down to our fourth sphere (the actual earth)—is a

grosser and more material copy of the more shadowy sphere which

precedes it in their successive order, on the three higher planes.

On its way upwards on the ascending arc, Evolution spiritualizes

and etherealizes, so to speak, the general nature of all, bringing it

on to a level with the plane on which the twin globe on the opposite

side is placed; the result being, that when the seventh globe is

reached (in whatever Round) the nature of everything that is

evolving returns to the condition it was in at its starting point—

plus, every time, a new and superior degree in the states of con-

sciousness. Thus it becomes clear that the 'origin of man,'

so-called, on this our present Round, or life-cycle on this planet,

must occupy the same place in the same order—save details based on

local conditions and time—as in the preceding Round." (I, 232-3 *)

An explanation in regard to "' the descending scale." It may be interpreted in two ways: (1) the progressive stages of the spheres on the downward or Descending Arc, or the Arc of Matter, representing the first Three and one half Rounds of the Seven Round cycle; (2) the passage of the Monadic Hosts through the Globes on the Descending Arc—Globes A, B, C and D. Similarly "on its way upwards on the ascending arc": may

refer to (1) the developmental stages of the globes upward on the Are of Spirit during the latter half of the Fourth Round as well as Rounds Five, Six and Seven; (2) the passage of the Life-Waves through the Globes on the Ascending Arc—Globes E, F and G. The “ twin globes” may

* Vol. I, p. 278, 6 vol, ed.; 1, 253, 3rd ed.

preceding Round ”’ is the Third Round. The Root-Races follow the same law, as explained in the Doctrine of the Races. Thus the First Root-Race of humanity was ethereal, each Race becoming more and more material as the cyclic journey progressed along the Descending Arc. One of the Stanzas of Dzyan gives the law —treferring specifically to the Earth—in symbolical manner:

And after great throes she (the Earth) cast off her old three and put on her new seven skins, and stood in her first (Stanza I, gloka 4) The gloka was introduced with these words:

** Archaic Scripture teaches that at the commencement of every local Kalpa, or Round, the earth is reborn: ‘as the human Fiva (monad), when passing into a new womb, gets re-covered with a new body, so does the Jiva of the Earth; it gets a more perfect and solid covering with each Round after re-emerging once more from the matrix of space into objectivity’ (Commentary). This process is attended, of course, by the throes of the new birth or geological convulsions.” (II, 46 *) This explanatory passage followed the loka:

Earth is said to cast off her old skins, because this

refers to the three preceding Rounds she has already passed through; the present being the fourth Round out of the seven. At the beginning of every new after a period of ‘ obscuration,’ the earth (as do also the other six ‘ earths ’) casts off, or is supposed to cast off, her old skins as the Serpent does: therefore she is called in the Aitareya-Brahmana the Sarpa Rajni, ‘ the Queen of the Serpents,’ and ‘the mother of all that moves’. The ‘ Seven Skins,’ in the first of which she now stands, refer to the seven geological changes which accompany and correspond to the evolution of the Seven Root-Races of Humanity.” (II, 47 f) With each progression on the Round-cycles along the Arc of Matter, each “‘skin”’ of the Earth becomes more material; with each advancing Round along the Arc of Spirit each “ becomes more ethereal. One’ short sentence describes the condition of the “‘ first of our Earth (Globe D) during the First Round:

“The globe was ‘ fiery, cool and radiant as its ethereal men and animals during the first Round,’ says the Commentary.” (I, 252 The especial significance of this succinct sentence is that it refers to the state of the Earth during the First Round, manifesting but one Element* Vol. III, p. 58, 6 vol. ed.; II, 50, 3rd ed. t Vol. III, pp. 58-9, 6 vol. ed.; II, 50, 3rd ed. * Vol. I, p. 297, 6 vol, ed.; I, 273, 3rd ed.

Principle is brought into evolutionary development in the course of one Round. The rationale of this teaching is to be found in a Commentary on the Stanzas of Dzyan, along with which the following teachings are included: (1) the origin of the Element-Principles (Tattvas) ; (2) the origin of manifested globes—and for that matter, all beings that have forms; (3) the

origin of the “ Lives” which build all the forms; (4) the origin of comets; (5) the origin of a sevenfold: planetary system—our Earth (Bhiimi) is specifically referred to with “‘ her six sisters,” that is, the seven globes of the Earth-Chain. Before giving the citation it would be well to repeat the seven Tattvas (Element-Principles)—the Sanskrit names being followed by their English equivalents:

1. Adi-tattva Original Element-Principle : “The One”

2. Anupapadaka-tattva Parentless Element-Principle or The

Spiritual

3. Acther Element-Principle

4. Taijasa or Tejas-tattva Fire Element-Principle

5. Vayu-tattva Air Element-Principle

6. Apas or Apas-tattva Water Element-Principle

7. Prithivi-tattva Earth Element-Principle In the citation, the words placed in parentheses are H. P. B.’s explanatory comments, along with her question-marks. 1 crore is equivalent to 10 million.

“*'The worlds, to the profane,’ says a Commentary, ‘ are built up of the known Elements. To the conception of an Arhat, these Elements are themselves collectively a divine Life; distributively, on the plane of manifestations, the numberless and countless crores of lives. Fire alone is One, on the plane of the One Reality: on that of manifested, hence illusive, being, its particles are fiery lives which live and have their being at the expense of every other life that they consume. Therefore they are named the ‘ DEvourERs.’ . . . Every visible thing in this

Universe was built by such Lives, from conscious and divine primordial man down to the unconscious agents that construct matter.' . . . 'From the One Lire formless and Uncreate, proceeds the Universe of lives. First was manifested from the Deep (Chaos) cold luminous fire (gaseous light?) which formed the curds in Space.' (Irresolvable nebulae, perhaps?) . *... These fought, and a great heat was developed by the encountering and collision, which produced rotation. Then came the first manifested MATERIAL, Fire, the hot flames, the wanderers in heaven (comets); heat generates moist vapor; that forms solid water (?); then dry mist, then liquid mist, watery, that puts out the luminous brightness of the pilgrims (comets?) and forms solid watery wheels

lobes). Bhimi (the Earth) appears with six sisters.

ese produce by their continuous motion the inferior fire, heat,

WATER; and from the breath of all (atmospheric) Arr is born,

These four are the four lives of the first four periods (Rounds) of

Manvantara. The three last will follow.'" (1, 249-50 *)

First as to the significance of the last two sentences: "' the four lives of the first four are the four Element-Principles to be developed during the first Four Rounds (numbered 4 to 7 preceding the citation): Fire, Air, Water, Earth Element-Principles. The Manvantara referred to is a Planetary Manvantara, equivalent to a period of activity of Seven Rounds. '' The three last will follow" refers to the three Rounds yet to be completed: Rounds Five, Six and Seven, bringing into

development the remaining Tattvas (Element-Principles) : AkaSa-tattva during the Fifth Round; Anupapadaka-tattva during the Sixth Round; Adi-tattva during the Seventh Round; thus completing the Round-development of the Element-Principles in their relationship to the spheres or globes of the Earth-Chain. Attention is called to this observation, added in explanation of the Commentary:

** This means that every new Round develops one of the Compound Elements, as now known to Science,—which rejects the primitive nomenclature, preferring to subdivide them into constituents. If Nature is the ‘ Ever-becoming’ on the manifested plane, then those Elements are to be regarded in the same light: they have to evolve, progress, and increase to the Manvantaric end.

‘Thus the First Round, we are taught, developed but one Element, and a nature and humanity in what may be called one aspect of Nature.” (I, 250 ft)

A question arises in regard to the development of Element-Principles in connection with the Rounds, which may be phrased in the following manner: Why is it that the Element-Principle of Fire is brought into development during the First Round, when it is classed as the fourth Element-Principle ?

First of all, it should be borne in mind that the Element-Principles are produced emanationally, just as are the Lokas and Talas.¢ . Thus the second Tattva (Element-Principle)

is emanated from the first—Adi-tattva; the third Element-Principle from the first and second—Anupapadakatattva; the fourth Tattva from the first, second and third—AkAga-tattva, Secondly, the importance of the Descending and Ascending Arcs in connection with the Round-cycles should also be held in mind: namely that the lowest point in the Arc of Descent occurs in the mid-point of the cycle of the Rounds, that is, during the Fourth Round. The emanational unfoldment of the Tattvas coincides with the lowest point in the Arc, so

* Vol. I, pp. 294-5, 6 vol. ed.; I, 269-70, 3rd ed.

t Vol. I, p. 295, 6 vol. ed.; I, 270, 3rd ed.

t Described in “ The Septenary Law," Chapter VI, sections 2 and 3,

Gao AD A © tuned S440 ea. ee Vy 2440-24 are situated the aripa globes (non-manifested globes)—during which period and on the ariipa globes, the emanation of the first three Tattvas occurs, thus bringing forth the fourth Tattva (Tejas-tattva), the Element-Principle of Fire, on the fourth cosmic plane. The suggestion is also offered that since the seven Tattvas are resultants from emanational unfoldment, each Tattva may be subdivided into, or is composed of, seven Element-Principles. In the same way the seven Principles of man’s constitution are emanational unfoldments and each principle is subdivided into seven ‘‘sub-principles”—known as the 49 Fires. Consequently the culmination of the Seven Rounds of cyclic development will bring forth into full evolution the 49 Element-Frinciples, and also the evolutionary unfoldment of the seven principles in man in their fullness—the 49 Fires.* Returning to the Commentary, a passage may be added in explanation of the

activity of the Devourers,"' described as the ""' fiery lives which live and have their being at the expense of every other life that they consume,"' since it is through their agency that the globes were built. The earth,

we are told, is built up for the first Round by the ' Devourers' which disintegrate and differentiate the germs of other lives in the Elements; pretty much, it must be supposed, as in the present stage of the world, the aerobes do, when, undermining and loosening the chemical structure in an organism, they transform animal matter and generate substances that vary in their constitutions. . . .

the ' Devourers' (in whom the men of science are

invited to see, with some show of reason, atoms of the Fire-Mist, if they will, as the Occultist will offer no objection to this); when the ' Devourers,' we say, have differentiated ' the fire-atoms' by a peculiar process of segmentation, the latter become life-germs, which aggregate according to the laws of cohesion and Then the life-germs produce lives of another kind, which work on the structure of our globes... .

** Thus, in the first Round, the globe, having been built by the primitive fire-lives, i.e., formed into a sphere—had no solidity, nor qualifications, save a cold brightness, nor form nor color; it is only towards the end of the First Round that it developed one Element which from its inorganic, so to say, or simple Essence became now in our Round the fire we know throughout the system. The Earth * Cf. The Mahatma Letters to A. P. Sinnett, " Every clement having its seven principles and every principle its seven sub-princivles."

lejas-tattva, may be cited in order to illustrate the procedure accomplished by all the Tattvas. one Element-Principle for each Round. In the citation X equals "' the one eternal immutable principle "':

"Take fire. D—the primal igneous principle resident in X—is the ultimate cause of every phenomenal manifestation of fire on all the globes of the chain. The proximate causes are the evoluted secondary agencies which severally control the seven descents of fire on each planet [globe]. . . ..D is a septenary compound of which the highest fraction is pure spirit. As we see it on our globe it is in its coarsest, most material condition, as gross in its way as is man in his physical encasement. In the next preceding globe to ours fire was less gross than here: on the one before that less still. And so the body of flame was more and more pure and spiritual, less and less gross and material on each antecedent planet [globe]. On the first of all in the manvantaric chain, it appeared as an almost pure objective shining—the Maha Buddhi, sixth principle of the eternal light. Our globe being at the bottom of the arc where matter exhibits itself in its grossest form along with spirit—when the fire element manifests itself on the globe next succeeding ours in the ascending arc it will be less dense than as we see it. Its spiritual quality will be identical with that which fire had on the globe preceding ours in the descending scale; the second globe of the ascending scale will correspond in quality with that of the second anterior globe to ours in the descending scale, etc. On each globe of the chain there are seven manifestations of fire of which the first in order will compare as to spiritual quality with the last manifestation on the next preceding planet [globe]: the process being reversed, as you will infer, with the opposite arc. The myriad specific manifestations of these six universal elements are in their turn

but the offshoots, branches or branchlets of the one single primordial ‘ Tree of Life’. * Vol. I, pp. 302-3, 6 vol. ed.; I, 278-9, 3rd ed. The reason that this “‘ principle” is not named may be gathered from the following pas-sage in The Mahatma Letters to A.P. Sinnett, pp. 90-1 : 2 “there is but one element and it is impossible to comprehend our system before a correct conception of it is firmly fixed in one’s mind. ... This element then is the— to speak metaphysically—one sub-stratum or nent cause of all manifestations in the phenomenal universe. The ancients speak of the five cognizable elements of ether, air, water, fire, earth, and ofthe one incognizable element the uninitiates) the 6th principle of the universe—call it Purusha Sakti, while to speak of the seventh outside the sanctuary was punishable with death.” t The Mahatma Latisrs to A. P, Sinnatt, p. 92.

Principle. Vayu-tattva, known as the Element of Air. It is called the second Element because of being the second tattva to be developed. However, as with the Element-Principle of Fire, that which was developed in the Second Round is not the Element of Air as we know it today. This is brought out in the citation:

** The Second Round brings into manifestation the second element —Air, that element, the purity of which would ensure continuous life to him who would use it. There have been two occultists only in Europe who have discovered and even partially applied it in practice, though its composition has always been known among the highest Eastern Initiates.) The ozone of the modern chemists is poison compared with the real universal solvent which could never be thought of unless it existed in nature. ‘ From the second Round, Earth—hitherto a foetus in the matrix of Space—began its real existence: it had developed individual sentient life, its second principle. The

second corresponds to the sixth (principle); the second is life continuous, the other, temporary.' *' (Commentary) (1, 260 *) The Third Round brings into the sixth tattva, Apastattva, known as the element of Water.

succession of primary aspects of Nature with which the

succession of Rounds is concerned, has to do, as already indicated, with the development of the 'Elements' (in the Occult sense)— Fire, Air, Water, Earth. We are only in the Fourth Round, and our catalogue so far stops short. The centres of consciousness (destined to develop into humanity as we know it) of the third Round arrived at a perception of the third Element, Water." (I, 252-3 f) Our present Round, the Fourth, is bringing into development the seventh tattva to be emanated, Prithivi-tattva, the Element-Principle of Earth. Thus, Round

Fourth transformed the gaseous fluids and plastic form of

our globe into the hard, crusted, grossly material sphere we are living on. 'Bhiimi' has reached her fourth principle." (I, 260 }) It should be stressed again that the Earth (Globe D) was in different states of physicality during each one of the Rounds. Even in the early

of the Fourth Round our globe was still more ethereal than physical. his is brought out in dealing with the subject of characteristics and types * Vol. I, pp. 303-4, 6 vol. ed.; I, 280, 3rd ed. t Vol. I, pp. 296-7, 6 vol. ed.; I, 272-3, 3rd ed. t Vol. I, p, 304, 6 vol. ed; 1, 280, 3rd ed.

transierred to the present, fourth Kound.

** Occultism says: ‘ The astral prototypes of the mineral, vegetable and animal kingdoms up to man have taken that time (300 million years) to evolve, re-forming out of the cast-off materials of the preceding Round, which, though very dense and physical in their own cycle, are relatively ethereal as compared with the materiality of our present middle Round. At the expiration of these 300 million years, Nature, on the way to the physical and material, down the arc of descent, begins with mankind and works downwards, hardening or materializing forms as it proceeds. Thus the fossils found in strata, to which an antiquity, not of cighteen, but of many hundreds of millions of years, must be ascribed, belong in reality to forms of the preceding Round, which, while living, were far more ethereal than physical, as we know the physical. That we perceive and disinter them as tangible forms, is due to the process of materialization or crystallization referred to, which took place subsequently, at the beginning of the Fourth Round, and reached its maximum after the appearance of man, proceeding parallel with his physical evolution. This alone illustrates the fact that the degree of materiality of the Earth changes pari passu with that of its inhabitants. And thus man now finds, as tangible fossils, what were once the (to his present senses) ethereal forms of the lower

(II, 68 *)

The words of a Commentary described conditions of the Earth prior to the Fourth Round, going back, in fact, to a period of 120 million years, before which age the Earth had become cool and hard, albeit in a different degree of physicality and not in its present state,

*** During the first seven crores of the Kalpa (70,000,000-years) the Earth and its two Kingdoms (mineral and vegetable), one already having achieved its seventh circle, the other, hardly nascent, are luminous and semi-ethereal, cold, lifeless, and In the eleventh crore the mother (Earth) grows opaque, and in the fourteenth the throes of adolescence take place. These convulsions of nature (geological changes) last until her twentieth crore of years, uninterruptedly, after which they become periodical, and at long intervals,'

The last change took place nearly twelve crores of years ago (120,000,000). But the Earth with everything on her face had become cool, hard and settled ages earlier. (Commentary, xxii)."

(II, 312 T)

* Vol. III, p. 78, 6 vol. ed.; II, 72, 3rd ed. t Vol. ILI, pp. 312-3, 6 vol, ed.; II, 326, 3rd ed.

OF man and the other Of nature, gocs on constantly during the evolutionary development of the Rounds. This cannot be repeated too often. As it is the principal theme of this section, another citation may help to emphasize the point. It also gives a sort of pre-view of what will occur in the later stages of this Round, as well as referring to the development of the next Element-Principle, during the next Round Fifth.

"The elements, whether simple or compound, could not have remained the samc since the commencement of the evolution of our chain, Everything in the Universe progresscs steadily in the Great Cycle, while incessantly going up and down in the smaller cycles. Nature is never stationary during manvantara, as it is ever becoming, not simply being; and mineral,

vegetable, and human life are always adapting their organisms to the then reigning Elements, and therefore those Elements were then fitted for them, as they are now for the life of present humanity. It will only be in the next, or fifth, Round that the fifth Element, Ether—the gross body of Akaga, if it can be called even that—will, by becoming a familiar fact of Nature to all men, as air is familiar to us now, cease to be as at present hypothetical, and also an ‘ agent’ for so many things. And only during that Round _ will those higher senses, the growth and development of which Aka§a subserves, be susceptible of a complete cxpansion. As indicated, a partial familiarity with the characteristic of matter—permeability— which should be developed concurrently with the sixth sense, may be expected to develop at the proper period in this Round. But with the next element added to our resources in the next Round, permeability will become so manifest a of matter, that the densest forms of this will seem to man’s perceptions as cbstructive to him as a thick fog, and no (I, 257-8 *) The Sixth Round will bring into development another ElementPrinciple, Anupapddaka-tativa, the Spiritual Element, with still greater changes both to the globe and to man. Finally the Seventh Round will bring forth Adi-tattva, the Primordial Element-Principle into full manifestation,

“Earth will reach her true ultimate form—(inversely in this to man)—her body shell—only toward the end of the manvantara

the Seventh Round. (I, 260 f) And, in conclusion, before the Earth reaches her Seventh Round, * Vol. I, pp. 301-2, 6 vol, ed.; I, 278, 3rd ed. t Vol. I, p. 904, 6 vol, ed.; I, 280, 3rd ed,

oons of the other planets, have or have not, as the case may

(I, 155-6 *)

4. THE RELATION OF ROUNDS AND WATCHERS

Vatcher" is one of the mystical terms of the Ancient Wisdom, ng the idea of guardianship extended by a Superior Being. Howess the especial field of supervision is designated, the term remains alizing one. Be that as it may, a Watcher signifies a highly d Being, who functions on the intelligence side of a system, rather the form side—even though the latter is generally regarded as the ve' side, which indeed it is. To use an analogy, which will be to everyone: in the field of construction work the intelligence represented by the architect, who designs and draws blue prints g the plan. He leaves the actual work to the masons, carpenters er laborers to carry out the plan. With materials of all kinds the n, or " Builders," make the plan visible, producing the form be sure, the Watchers are in absolute accord with the Divine One of their functions is to assist those who are on the lower rungs sadder of Life, so that they too may work in consonance with the Plan. As a of the Stanzas of Dzyan expresses it: 'Then the Builders, having donned their first clothing, descend radiant earth, and reign over men—who are themselves." anza VII, sloka 7) 'The ' Watchers' reign over man during the whole period of ya Yuga and the smaller subsequent yugas, down to the beginning the Third Root-Race; after which it is the Patriarchs, Heroes, 1 the Manes, the incarnated Dhydnis of a lower order... . And t [Secret] Doctrine says that the Dhyani-Buddhas of the two her groups, namely, the ' Watchers' or the ' Architects,' furnished /many and various races with divine kings and leaders. It is latter who taught humanity their arts and sciences, and the

mer who revealed to the incarnated Monads that had just ken off their vehicles of the lower Kingdoms—and who had, refore, lost every recollection of their divine origin—the great ritual truths of the transcendental worlds. * Thus, as expressed in the Stanza, the Watchers descended on rth and reigned over men—‘ who are themselves.’ The reigning gs had finished their cycle on Earth and other worlds, in the ceding Rounds. In the future manvantaras they will have *n to higher systems than our planetary world; and it is the Elect our Humanity, the Pioneers on the hard and difficult path 1. I, pp. 210-1, 6 vol, ed.; I, 179-80, 3rd ed.

(1, 266-7 *) Equivalent terms to Watchers arc: Rectors, Lords of Being, Seven Sublime Lords, Lhas and Dhyanis (of the Stanzas of Dzyan), Manus (of Hindu literature); and Dhyani-Buddhas (in the Northern Buddhistic scheme). The words of a Commentary called attention to this similarity in the usc of terms, at the same time stressing the function of these Beings. by referring to them as Informing Intclligences.

Thus there is but onc Absolute Upadhi (basis) in the spiritual sensc, from, on, and in which, are built for Manvantaric purposes the countless basic centres on which procecd the Universal, cyclic, and individual Evolutions during the active period.’ ” The words ‘‘ basic centres”? were made equivalent to “‘ Spheres of Being,” or ‘‘ centres of life,” or again ‘centres of Being” (in the next following paragraph from the Commentary. ‘The active is. equivalent to a Manvantara. Continuing the Commentary:

““‘* The informing Intclligences, which animate these various centres of Being, are referred to indiscriminately by men beyond the Great Range [i.e., Hindusthan] as the Manus, the Rishis, the Pitris, the Prajapatis, and so on; and as

Dhyani-Buddhas, the Chohans, Melhas (fire-gods), Bodhisattvas, and others, on this side. The truly ignorant call them gods; the learned profane, the one God; and the wise, the Initiates, honor in them only the Manvan-taric manifestations of THat which neither our Creators (the Dhyan-Chohans) nor their creatures can ever discuss or know anything about. The is not to be defined, and no mortal or immortal has ever seen or comprehended it during the periods of Existence. The mutable cannot know the Immutable, nor can that which lives perceive Absolute (II, 34 f) Technically a Dhyani-Buddha, or Watcher, has governance of one Round; a Dhyani-Bodhisattva (also a Watcher) watches over a Globe; a Super-Terrestrial Bodhisattva watches over a Race and is assisted by two Manushya-Buddhas.

the Esoteric System, the watch successively over

one of the Rounds and the great Root-races of our planetary chain. They are, moreover, said to send their Bodhisattvas, the human correspondents of the Dhyani-Buddhas during every Round and Race. Out of the Seven Truths and Revelations, or rather revealed secrets, four only have been handed to us, as we are still in we Fourth Round, and the world also has only had four Buddhas, so far.... * Vol. I, pp. 309-10, 6 vol. ed.; I, 287-8, 3rd ed, t Vol. III, pp, 46-7, 6 vol. ed.; II, 37, 3rd ed.

the Hindus and Buddhists, For a simular reason Lrenaeus insisted on the necessity of Four Gospels. But as every new Root-race at the head of a Round must have its revelation and revealers, the next Round will bring the Fifth, the following the Sixth, and so on,”

(I, 42 *)

In the Brahmanical scheme, as given in the Puranas and the Laws of mu, both the Races and the Rounds are under the guidance of Manus, nce the term is not specific, especially when it is stated that each Manu reates'? 7X7 Manus. In this case the Manus refer to the Races and y be explained in the following way. Each Round-Manu " emanates chhaya his representative—to a globe (a Dhyani-Bodhisattva) ; o in turn emanates seven Manus, for each Race, and seven Manus for h Sub-Race—49 Manus. Then the Manus are described as watching over the Rounds. The sent " Watcher," named Vaivasvata, is stated to be the seventh Manu hough the present Round is the Fourth). The apparent confusion in ard to the seventh Manu, however, is easily explained, as may be scen the scriptures. In place of only seven Round-Manus, fourteen are imerated: seven are termed Root-Manus, seven are Seed-Manus. At beginning of a Round, on the first globe of the Chain (Globe A) comes Root-Manu; then at the close of the Round on the last globe of the ain (Globe G) the Seed-Manu appears. Thus the first Manu, the ot-Manu, represents the Manu watching over the Life-Waves during period of their activity on the seven globes—that is while performing ir seven stages of development on each globe during the Round-cycle, en the closing Manu, the Seed-Manu, takes over the watch, reigning + the Sishtas who remain on each of the seven globes of the Chain ing the period of dormancy (the resting period) between the Rounds. reality it is but one Watcher represented by two aspects: the state of ivity and the state of dormancy. 'The idea is similar to the dual aspect the loka-talas. The loka represents the spirit-side and the tala, the tter-side: the two sides of one coin. Vaivasvata is regarded as the seventh Manu, presiding over the sent Round as the Root-Manu, because three

Rounds have been fully npleted, with one Root-Manu and one Seed-Manu for each Round. e Fourth Round is still in process of development. The names of the fourteen Manus are enumerated in the Puranas. numbering a Root-Manu and a Seed-Manu for each Round, it will be n that the two aspects of a Manu (that is, watching over a period of ivity and a period of dormancy) govern the seven Round-periods, * Vol. I, pp. 114-5, 6 vol. ed.; 1, 73-4, 3rd ed.

Svirochi (or Svarochisha)—on Globe G: Ist Secd-Manu) Auttami —on Globe A: 2nd Root-Manu ‘Tiimasa —on Globe G: 2nd Raivata —on Globe A: 3rd Root-Manu . Chikshusha —on Globe G: 3rd Vaivasvata —on Globe A: 4ih Root-Manu) Sfiivarna —on Globe G: 4th Sccd-Manu § ROUND 4 Daksha Savarna —on Globe A: 5th Root-Manu Brahma Savarna —on Globe G: 5th aa ROUNDS Dharma Savarna —on Globe A: 6th Root-Manu ROUND 6 Rudra Sfvarna —on Globe G: 6th ct Rauchya —on Globe A: 7th Root-Manu ROUND 7 Bhautya —on Globe G: 7th

5. THE RELATION OF ROUNDS AND THE

AFTER-DEATH STATES

It should be clear that the Doctrine of the Rounds deals with periods of cyclical activity to time-periods covering many millions of years. At first glance, then, it would seem incompatible with the main theme to consider what may be called an “ state, or condition, since that is what the post-mortem state is for one part of man’s ‘‘ Yet individualized as it is for one part, it is cosmic in scope for another portion of man’s being. After all, it may be remarked in passing, that unless the Doctrines of the Rounds and Races are thoroughly understood

as an intellectual pursuit, but made something to live by, or, better yet, incorporated into the fibre of one’s being, so to speak—then both the afier-death state, as well as the phase of existence on carth, become solely individualized. For, since knowledge of the Round-cycles is lacking, man seems to be going “‘ against the current” of the Round activity, striving for his own ends, instead of working in harmony with the mighty, pulsating rhythms which in reality keep all life cycling on the Circle of Necessity. So one may be justified in adding parenthctically, that the first Nidana (the first bond which fetters man to carth-lifc) is indecd responsible for so much sorrow in the world—Avidya, or non-knowledge of the Divine Plan.

It hardly seems necessary to make the statement that the Doctrine of the Rounds bases its teaching upon the Doctrine of Constant Renewal. Yet it cannot be repeated too often that it is the Monad which utilizes vehicle after vehicle for temporary

appearances upon the globe on which the Human Life-Wave is functioning, in order to accomplish the Circle of Necessity. Nevertheless, a strange paradox exists: although it is necessary

le of Necessity, thus continuing on the cycle of the Rounds, the of such vestures renders the Monad unable to contact other s of life (spheres) with which it has a close relationship (outlined Joctrine of the Spheres), in order that it may accomplish other

It must wait for this close contact with other spheres until it is m the bond which holds it fast. This bond is the phase of existence fe on earth. Freedom from this fetter is achieved when another ‘existence is entered into—known as “‘ death.” Then the Monad ed to continue its cyclic journeys to other spheres—first of all to r globes of this planetary chain, then on to the other spheres with it is linked. So that other Rounds are continued during the ith state. s is the fundamental idea underlying the doctrine of Gilgilim, octrine may be utilized to explain the relationship of Rounds to r-death states: However, although Gilgillim was a teaching of ient Chaldaean Kabbala, it has been sadly misunderstood by 1 Kabbalists, in the same way that the Pythagorean of Metempsychosis has been misinterpreted and not understood > who consider the literal meaning of words, without knowledge tent conveyed by the doctrines. st of all the Kabbalistic ideas on Metempsychosis should be borne . These are epitomized in the well-known Kabbalistic axiom: * th becomes a stone, the stone becomes a plant, the plant an animal, mal a man, the man a the spirit—God. This doctrine is linked with that of the Gilgilim, and it is obvious that the goal | by the axiom is only achieved by means of reincarnation, is a Hebrew word which may be translated as revolutions or

conveying to Kabbalists the idea of the cycle of rebirths. That y the word itself means the revolutions or rounds which the Monad ake until attaining its goal—the goal having been given the namé lestine'". However, medieval Kabbalists developed the concept ite a different form, not at all implied in the original Kabbala, ng the notion that when the bodies of Jews are buried in strange is Mackenzie's Royal Masonic Cyclopaedia has it, there is within them '* a principle of Soul which cannot rest, until by a process called "whirling of the Soul" the immortal particle reaches once re the sacred Soil of the '* Promised Land".' . . . The process s supposed to be accomplished by a kind of metempsychosis, the chic spark being conveyed through bird, beast, fish; and the st minute insect." (I, 568 ft) wever, the explanation of this portion of the doctrine of Gil ame that applies to the Pythagorean doctrine of Metempsychosis is axiom has been explained in Chapter V, " The Doctrine of Continuous Change 4 1 3 1 2 0 0 2018 570 38 -1 5 1 3 1 2 1 0 2014 27 46 58.195705 1,5 1 3 1 2 2 35 2020 80 36 62.882015 II,5 1 3 1 2 3 92 2014 27 46 91.429367 p.5 1 3 1 2 4 130 2014 57 46 96.141655 202,5 1 3 1 2 5 203 2020 12 28 96.816093 65 1 3 1 2 6 230 2014 50 46 90.518143 vol.5 1 3 1 2 7 295 2014 54 46 88.823959 od.;5 1 3 1 2 8 360 2019 24 33 80.935936 I,5 1 3 1 2 9 402 2014 53 46 96.208221 621,5 1 3 1 2 10 471 2014 39 46 89.762100 3rd5 1 3 1 2 11 525 2014 45 46 88.695312 ed.

bodies of animals but

'The allegory relates to the atoms of the body, which have each to pass through every form before all reach the final state, which is the first starting point of the departure of every atom—its primitive laya State. But the primitive meaning of Gilgoolem, or * Revolution of Souls,' was the idea of the re-incarnating Souls or Egos. ' All the Souls go into the

gilgoolah,' into a cyclic or revolving process; 1.€., they all proceed on the cyclic path of re-births. Some Kabalists interpret this doctrine to mean only a kind of purgatory for the souls of the wicked. But this is not so." (I, 568 *) After the second sentence in the following citation, another author (Valentinus in his Esoteric Treatise on the Doctrine of Gilgul) is quoted, who gives another interpretation of the Kabbalistic doctrine:

'No ancient philosopher, not even the Jewish Kabalists, ever dissociated Spirit from matter or vice versa. Everything originated in the Ong, and, proceeding from the One, must finally return to the One. ' Light becomes heat, and consolidates into fiery particles; which, from being ignited, become cold, hard particles, round and smooth. And this is called Soul, imprisoned in its robe of matter'; Atoms and Souls having been synonymous in the language of the Initiates. The ' whirling Souls,' Gilgoolem, a doctrine in which so many learned Jews have believed, had no other meaning esoterically. The learned Jewish Initiates never meant by the ' Promised land' Palestine alone, but the same Wirvdna as the learned Buddhist and Brahman do—the bosom of the One, symbolized by that of Abraham, and by Palestine as its substitute on Earth." (I, 568 f) It needs but the substitution of the word Monads for or Egos" and the addition of on the Spheres, to have the full explanation of the doctrine—namely, that the whirling of the Monad continues on the

during the after-death states. This interpretation is borne out by © very next sentence:

"The passage of the Sovut-Arom 'through the Seven Planetary Chambers' had the same metaphysical and also physical meaning."

(I, 568 $)

As to the “‘ physical meaning.” This signifies the passage of the life-atoms (Jivanus), already referred to, through the lower seven kingdoms on the hierarchical Ladder of Life, the Human Host representing the seventh Kingdom on the Ladder. With the death of the body, the cohering force holding the life-atoms together into the mould or pattern of * Vol. II, p. 292, 6 vol. ed.; I, 621, 3rd ed. t Vol. IL, p. 291, 6 vol. ed.; I, 620, 3rd ed. t Vol. LI, p. 292, 6 vol, ed.; I, 621, 3rd ed.

the Linga-sarira (the Model body) and the othwa-satira (the Body) as well as the dominating overseership of the Monad, no longer exerts its influence. Consequently the life-atoms are free to pursue their journeys, transmigrating (that is, passing from kingdom to kingdom) until they are attracted to their proper respective kingdoms. In regard to the metaphysical meaning: the “‘ Seven Planetary Chambers” have reference to chambers so named within the Great Pyramid: the Chamber of Saturn, the Chamber of Jupiter, the Chamber of Mars, the Chamber of Venus, the Chamber of Mercury, the Lunar Chamber, the Solar Chamber. As to the architectural symbology of the Pyramid itself: ** The apex is lost in the clear blue sky of the land of the Pharaohs, and typifies the primordial point lost in the unseen universe from whence started the first race of the spiritual prototypes of man.” * Observe the following passage, using the suggested changes (given previously) :

** Fach mummy, from the moment that it was embalmed, lost its physical individuality in one sense; it symbolized the human race, Placed in such a way as was best calculated to aid the exit of the ‘ soul,’ the latter had to pass through the seven planetary chambers before it made its exit through the symbolical apex. Each chamber typified, at the same time, one of the seven

sphcres, and one of the seven higher types of physico-spiritual humanity alleged to be above our own. Every 3,000 years, the soul, representative of its race, had to return to its primal point of departure before it underwent another evolution into a more perfected spiritual and physical transformation. We must go deep indeed into the abstruse metahysics of Oriental mysticism before we can realize fully the infinitude of the subjects that were embraced at one sweep by the majestic thought of its exponents." f * Isis Unveiled, Vol. 1, pp. 296-7.

relation of Rounds and Principles covers the [caching ee eee reference to the Human Kingdom—that one principle of the seven, of which man is constituted, is completely developed in one Round. As this is the Fourth Round, the fourth principle, Kama (the desire-principle) is undergoing its major developmental phases.

"Tt is not in the course of natural law that man should become

a perfect septenary being, before the seventh race in the seventh

Round. Yet he has all these principles latent in him from his birth.

Nor is it part of the evolutionary law that the Fifth principle

(Manas), should receive its complete development before the Fifth

Round. . . . Even in the coming seventh Race, at the close of this

Fourth Round, while our four lower principles will be fully devel-

oped, that of Manas will be only proportionately so." (II,, 167 *)

Expressed in a mystical symbol used in the Stanza of Dzyan, man is a Saptaparna (a “‘seven-leaved plant’); one parna is unfolded in each Round. As the word parna means a leaf, it may be said that a parna stands for one principle. In seven Rounds all the leaves will be unfolded.

Another symbolical way of expressing this teaching is provided in a Commentary:

needs four flames and three fires to become one on

Earth, and he requires the essence of the forty-nine fires to be

perfect.’”? (II, 57 f)

In explanation. The Four Flames are represented by the perishable quaternary, the four lower principles: Sthila-Sarira (the physical body), Linga-Sarira (the model body), Prana (the life-principle), Kama (the desire-principle). The Three Fires stand for the imperishable triad, the three higher principles: Manas (the mind-principle); Buddhi (the dis¢eriminating principle) ; Atman (the universal principle). The “‘ essence of the forty-nine may be rendered as the seven principles subdivided into seven—the seven with the seven, 7X7=49. In other words, the « seven within the seven” stand for the seven principles with their septenary aspects, that is, each one of the seven principles consists of seven aspects: 7x7=49. In the words of a Commentary:

also with man and every “man” in man (every prin-

ciple).’” (II, 29 $)

In order to elucidate what is meant by “every man in man,” the seventh principle, Atman, may be taken to illustrate the point: Within a

* Vol, III, p. 175, 6 vol. ed.; II, 177, 3rd ed.

t Vol. III, p. 67, 6 vol. ed.; 1, 60, 3rd ed.

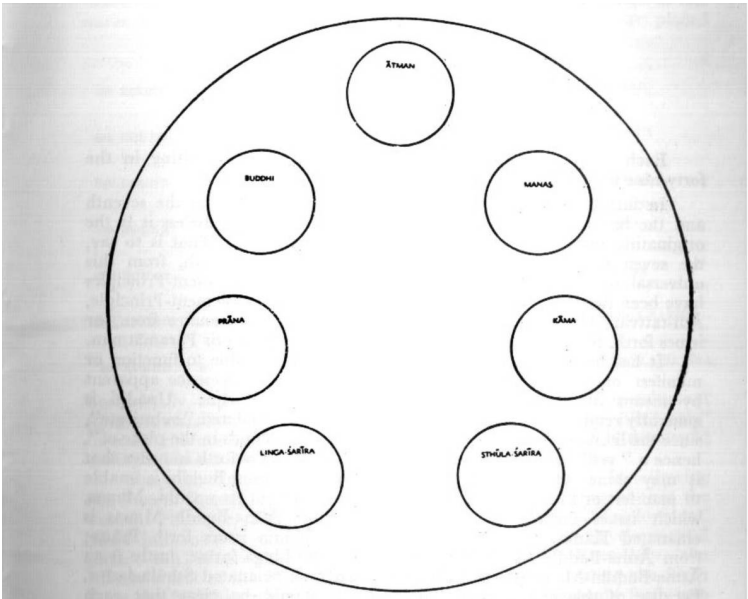
¢ Vol. p, 42, 6 vol. ed.; 11, 32, 3rd ed.

A DIAGRAMMATIC REPRESENTATION OF “EVERY ‘MAN’ IN MAN”

en cant of the seven principles of man. indicates

de esa Divine Man”—are placed seven

ee within each one of the seven Bg oar goer The complete dia~ should show each one of the seven principles as a large s ee ee ren of Ge seven large apheves : ° ‘every ‘man’inman”. In their they represent the 49 Fires,



A DIAGRAMMATIC REPRESENTATION OF "EVERY 'MAN' IN MAN"

Within a large sphere representing Ātman—"Divine Man"—are placed seven small globes. Each globe stands for one of the seven principles of man. This indicates that there are seven principles within *each one* of the seven principles. The *complete* diagram should show each one of the seven principles as a large sphere, having seven globes within each one of the seven large spheres: "every 'man' in man". In their totality they represent the 49 Fires.

Kenan Thus tt

each sphere representing an aspect of Atman. Thus there is the

Sthila-garira aspect of Atman

Linga-Sarira aspect of Atman

Prana aspect of Atman

Kama aspect of Atman

Manas aspect of Atman

Buddhi aspect of Atman

Atman aspect of Atman

Each principle may be listed in the same way, resulting in the forty-nine fires.

In further explanation: although Atman is regarded as the seventh and the last principle to be completely developed, nevertheless it is the originating principle from the standpoint of emanation. That is to say, the seven principles are emanated from, or unrolled forth, from this universal principle. In the same manner the seven Element-Principles have been described as emanating from the originating Element-Principle, Kadi-tattva. Similarly, in the case of a universe, it emanates from, or issues forth, from its originating Central Point—its Atman or Paramatman.

It has been repeatedly asserted that Atman is unable to function or manifest on the physical plane, but must make its presence apparent by means of its upadhi, which is the Buddhi-principle. Upadhi is generally rendered “4 vehicle,” but it may also be rendered “‘ since the literal meaning of the word is ‘‘ that which stands in the place of”, hence a “‘ veil”, or ‘‘ veil of spirit”, which Atman issues forth in order that it may shine through the emanation. However, even Buddhi is unable to manifest or function on the physical plane without its upadhi, Manas, which issues forth from From Atma-Buddhi-Manas is emanated Kama; from Atma-Buddhi-Manas-Kama issues forth Prana; from Atma-Buddhi Manas-K4ma-Prana ‘unrolls Linga-Sarira; lastly from

Atma-Buddhi-Manas-K4ma-Prana-Linga-Sarifa is emanated Sthiila-Sarira. Because of this emanational “descent it should be clear that each principle partakes not only of its proximate emanating principle, but the whole series of principles. In so far as the evolutionary development of a principle in a Round is concerned,

“it is sinyply this: every * Round’ brings about a new develop-

ment and even an entire change in the mental, psychic, spiritual

and physical constitution of man, all these principles evoluting on

an ever ascending scale.” (I, 162 *)

Another diagram serves to indicate the development of one principle for cach Round, as well as to represent the 49 Fires. On the left-hand side the Rounds are indicated; on the right-hand side the Principles, one for each Round. The principles are placed in emanational descent, 80

Vol. I, p. 216, 6 vol. ed; I, 185, Srd ed.

er Of ascent, pointing to the spiralling advance Or Clim) that 18 Under} en during the Circle of Necessity, one Round being equivalent to one ve of the spiralling ascent. Again, the seven principles are placed

STHOLA LINGA

SARTRA RIRA = PRANA KAMA MANAS BUDDHI ATMAN

ROUND x te tr x ATMAN

‘ROUND x * & * * BUDDHI

x te vr vr * tr vy MANAS

x w v * vr w KAMA

ve * wt sx PRANA

x * * w tr sx LINGA-SARIRA

+ rt tt t od sx STHULA-SARTRA,

izontally, each principle being portrayed by seven “ stars” in columnar m, six stars being “‘ open,” the seventh one “‘ filled”. The “ filled star” each column serves to show the especial principle that is developed ing a Round. Since the Human Host of Monads is at present engaged in following Fourth Round, in the spiralling ascent, it will be apparent that the wth Principle, Kama, is undergoing its pre-eminent development, ce humanity is engaged in unfolding the fifth major developmental

being equivalent to what is termed the Fifth Root-Race—the

nas-aspect of the Kama principle is being stressed. During the Sixth se the Buddhi-aspect of the Kama principle will be brought forth into clopment. Then during the Seventh Race the Atman-aspect of | receive its pre-eminent unfoldment. During the Fifth Round the Manas-principle will be unfolded in all sevenfold aspects. In the diagram the stars" serve to indicate the six other ects of each Principle. The " filled represents the fully developed nciple for the Round.

evertheless, a word of caution relative to diagrammatic representa1s should be added. A diagram is useful to illustrate a specific point, at the same time the diagrammatic representation is apt to be misdling in regard to other aspects of the teaching. Thus it would be

to regard the 49 Fires as being distinct and separable portions, from the other. All the 49 Fires interpenctrate each other, just as

this manner solely for purposes of study.

In the case of the 49 Fires, thus portrayed in diagrammatic manner, the illustration serves to call attention to the fact that some of the Fires have been "lighted" or developed, particularly those that pertain to the lower principles. On the other hand the Fires of the higher principles await or unfoldment in future Rounds. In fact, all the Fires

to the superior Rounds are at present dormant. In so far as

is higher principles are concerned, man is still unenlightened. Nevertheless there is the possibility of effecting this enlightenment. Examples of this do appear on earth now and then.

“© All such prematurely developed intellects (on the spiritual

plane) in our Race are abnormal; they are those whom we call the

‘ Fifth-Rounders’.” (II, 167 *)

FIFTH-ROUNDERS

Just what is meant by the term “ Fifth-Rounders”? The technical meaning signifies that the development of the fourth principle, Kama, has been completed in all its sevenfold aspects. That is to say, all the Fires. of Kama have been lit. Following this, the effort is being made to unfold, or develop the fifth principle, Manas, until all of its sevenfold aspects are brought into development. ‘This will be the developmental phase to be undertaken on the fifth cycling during the spiralling ascent of this planetary manvantara. In other words Manas will be fully develeped at the conclusion of the Fifth Round.

Since humanity is proceeding on its fourth cycling of the spiralling ascent, the vast majority of the human race is engaged in developing Fourth Round phases. Fourth-Rounders are therefore predominant. Those referred to (in the citation) as “ prematurely developed intellects on the spiritual plane” are forerunners. They have forged ahead. They are called Fifth-Rounders. Thus the F ifth-Rounders exemplify the process

of the unfolding of the higher aspect of the Manas-principle.

“Thence it follows that those persons who, like Confucius and

Plato, belonged psychically, mentally, and spiritually to the higher

planes of evolution, were in our Fourth Round as the average man.

will be in the Fifth Round, whose mankind is destined to find itself,

on this scale of Evolution, immensely higher than is our present

humanity.” (I, 162 f)

A technical explanation of how the development of the Fifth-Rounders has been effected is available:

* Vol. III, p. 175, 6 vol. ed.; II, 177, 3rd ed.

Vol. 1, p. 216, 6 vol. ed.; 1. 185, 3rd ed.

has but begun his first on Z and as A dies when he leaves it for B, etc., and as he must also remain in the inter-cyclic sphere after Z, as he has between every two planets until the impulse again thrills the chain, clearly no one can be more than one round ahead of his kind.” *

his seventh ring upon A" signifies completing the

enth major developmental phase, or the Race" upon the t globe of the terrestrial chain—globe A. "Z" has reference to the most sphere or globe of the chain. It will be noticed that the phrase d is that Globe A dies—not that it goes into pralaya. In so far as the nan life-wave is concerned, Globe A has finished its evolutionary cycle the Round, and continues its existence in a state of dormancy *' obscuration"), until the human life-wave returns to Globe A for next Round of cyclic development. The word "etc." after Globe B

The "'inter-cyclic period" refers to the ef Rounds, known technically as the Sandhyas and (** dawns " and The inter-cyclic period also refers to the interval following the completion of the seven Races on a globe and the inauguration of the Life-Wave on the next globe of the Chain. Another citation explains what is accomplished by the fore-runners of the human race: "The scheme with its septenary details would be incomprehensible to man had he not the power as the higher Adepts have proved of prematurely developing his 6th and 7th senses—those which will be the natural endowment of all in the corresponding rounds. Our Lord Buddha—a 6th round man—would not have appeared in our epoch, great as were his accumulated merits in previous rebirths but for a mystery... - Individuals cannot outstrip the humanity of their round any further than by one It was in connection with a question. regarding Fifth-Rounders that the celebrated remark was penned:

"A few drops of rain do not make the Monsoon, though they presage it." (I, 162 T) It is because of the interpenetration of the seven principles—that is to say, the "seven within the seven,"

making the 49 Fires—that man is able to evoke his superior principles, which the Round development will unfold in the course of ages. Yet there is a way of speeding up the process. It is achieved by means of initiations.

The chief object of our struggles and initiations is to achieve this union while yet on this earth. Those who will be successful have nothing to fear of during the fifth, sixth and seventh rounds." The "union" referred to is a blending of "' the three into one—the sixth "'. That is, blending the fourth, fifth and seventh principles—Kama, Manas and Atman—into the sixth principle, Buddhi. For—

"The degrees of an Adept's initiation mark the seven stages at which he discovers the secret of the sevenfold principles in nature and man and awakens his dormant § * The Mahatma Letters to A. P. Sinnett, p- 96. t Vol. I, p. 216, 6 vol. ed.; I, 185-6, 3rd ed. 4 The Mahatma Letters to A, P. Sinnett, p- 78. § p. 99.

Admittedly, the subject of the Outer Rounds is in the nature of a sed book (to use a familiar expression) to many. This is so especially . distinction has not been made between the Inner Rounds and the ter Rounds. Nevertheless there is a precise meaning applicable to h term. That a distinction was required made clear by the

who first presented the Esoteric Philosophy, as this passage icates:

may feel sure that neither M. nor I have contradicted

each other in our respective statements. He was speaking of the inner—I, of the outer Round." * Wherein lies the difference ? A definition has been given for the Inner Rounds, namely, the passage he Monadic Hosts from globe to globe within the circuit of the seven bes of a planetary chain. Further clarification explained that the circuit of the seven globes sists of two phases: (1) the circling on the Descending Arc, constituting passage of the Life-Waves from Globes A to D; (2) the circling on the ending Arc, consisting of the passage of the Monadic Hosts from Globes o G. 'Both phases are aspects of the Inner Rounds. The Outer Rounds may be defined as the passage of Monads from » planetary chain to another planetary chain and beyond . . . . thus icating that the circling is outside the "' Home" planetary chain. Since relationship has been shown to exist between the Monad and the en Sacred Planets (in the Doctrine of the Spheres), the passage of the mad to and from the members of this system would be a means of illing the obligations of the relationship (using the analogy of a family tlucidate the point), at the same time preserving the bond of attachment, is cyclic journey continues during the life of the Solar Logos, or during

of a Solar Manvantara. In the Doctrine of the Spheres, under the section entitled The Doctrine Gyelic Journeys, the teaching was presented regarding the transference

energy, termed the One Life-Force, from the pulsating heart of the lem to its members. The sun represents the heart and brain of the lem, while the planets are its arteries and veins. There is no need to @at the doctrine here,t but because of its importance and bearing upon subject of the Outer Rounds, a

portion of a Commentary will now be eated;

* (xxi) ‘The real substance of the concealed (Sun) is a nucleus of Mother substance. It is the heart and matrix of all the living * The Mahatma Letters to A. P. Sinnett, p. 392.

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which proceed to spread on their cyclic journeys all the Powers

that set in’ action the atoms in their functional duties, and the

focus within which they again meet in their SEVENTH ESSENCE every

eleventh year.’” (I, 290 *)

This shows that there is a regular rhythmic pulsation between the: Janets and the sun: a flowing to the sun of the vital energy in order that it may be revitalized, as well as a streaming forth from the sun of this life essence. This represents a continuous circulation of life-force representative of the cyclic journeys of the Outer Rounds, as basic and fundamental as is the circuit of the Inner Rounds on the Circle of Necessity.

The next phase of the Doctrine of the Outer Rounds deals with the ose of the Monads themselves. Just as it is necessary for the One ife-Force of the system to be revivified at its source by means of the circuit performed on the Outer Rounds, so is it equally needful for the Monads, as sparks from the Vital Flame

(to use an analogy), to become “ re-charged ” from their originating Source. As presented in the section entitled The Relation of Rounds and the After-Death States, under the doctrine of (the Whirling of the Monads), the Monad “‘ had to return to its primal point of departure,” that is, return to its originating Source, “ before it underwent another evolution,” that is, before returning to earth in order to take on another vesture—or, as we say, become reborn on earth again. It was also: shown that the required cyclic journey necessitated a passage through the Seven Planetary Chambers,” that is, the Seven Spheres, or the Seven Sacred Planets. A passage will now be given indicating the cyclic journeys of the Outer Rounds. It is introduced by means of this sentence:

‘The Planetary origin of the Monad (Soul) and of its faculties

was taught by the Gnostics.” (I, 577 *)

This aspect of the teaching was fully covered in the section entitled The Doctrine of the Relationship of the Monads to the System.t The word “faculties”? may also be rendered “ principles”, which was also considered. Continuing the citation:

its way to the Earth, as on its way back from the Earth,

each soul born in, and from, the ‘Boundless Light,’ had to pass

through the seven planetary regions both ways.” (I, 577 $)

The Gnostic term “ Boundless Light ” is indeed an excellent way of expressing the originating Source of the Monad. What could be more majestic than the splendour of that Flame which is inextinguishable and which encompasses infinitude! Observe the importance of the words

* Vol. I, p. $31, 6 vol. ed.; 1, 310, 3rd ed.

t Vol. IL, p. 300, 6 vol, ed.; I, 630, Srd ed.

In Chapter VII, The Doctrine of the Spheres.

nets on its departure from the earth—when the Monad is lberated n its bonds by means of that which is called "‘ death" on earth. Then en the return cyclic journey from the Boundless Light is made, the mad again passes through the Seven Sacred Planets on its way to take another vesture on Earth—to be born again, in order to take up the ‘rrupted Circle of Necessity occasioned by its departure on the Outer unds, Before giving the names of the Seven Sacred Planets as they were wn by the Gnostics, as recorded by the Christian Father, Origen,* entence calls attention to the fact that the original concept regarding Planetary Regents, or Dhydnis, has been altered in some religions, 0 was done is explained in a later paragraph, but may well be d first:

**As usual, that which is and was from its beginning divine, pure, and spiritual in its earliest unity, became, by reason of its differentiation by the distorted prism of man's conceptions, human and impure, as reflecting man's own sinful nature." (I, 577 f) Does not this account for the strange stories about the malpractices of ls and goddesses found in religions? But to return to the citation:

pure Dhyani and Devas of the oldest religions had become,

in course of time, with the Zoroastrians, the Seven Devs, the ministers of Ahriman, ‘each chained to his planet’; with the Brahmans, the Asuras and some of its Rishis—good, bad and indifferent; and among the Egyptian Gnostics it was Thoth (or Hermes) who was the chief of the seven whose names are given by Origen as Adonai, genius of the Sun; Tao [Iao] of the Moon; Eloi,

iter; Sabao, of Mars; Qrai, of Venus; Astaphai, of Mercury;

ldabaoth (Jehovah), of Saturn.” (I, 577 f) The interplay of the Outer Rounds and Inner Rounds, as the Monad

its cyclic journeys, is a fascinating study. It demonstrates the monious working of the Divine Laws in consonance with the Divine h. It illustrates the fact that the Monad is ‘‘ at home” at any spot in Universe—since law and order prevail throughout the kosmos. This also brings out the truth of the hierarchical pattern upon which universe is builded (which was the theme of Chapter III). For, as f proceeds on the Circle of Necessity, he discovers that he is ever

his horizon, ever extending his range of consciousness, as he

to function in wider ranges of existence. * In his celebrated work Contra Celsum, Bk, VI, xxiv, xxxxviii. Vol, IL, p. $01, 6 vol. ed.; I, 631, 3rd ed, Vol. 11, pp. 300-1, 6 vol, ed.; I, 630-1; 3rd ed,

DEERE: ee the sphere in which the Human Life-Wave is carrying on its major developmental stages—by means of the Seven Root-Races. Through his aconslong cyclical journey, Man has already learned to function in each one of the kingdoms on the Ladder of Life extending below his hierarchy, as the Monad

has progressed up the rungs of the Ladder, one by one.

‘As the Inner Rounds carry the Human Life-Wave from globe to globe of the planetary chain, Man learns through experience on each globe how to evolve on each sphere. For the most part, however, the cyclic journey on the Ascending Arc of the Inner Rounds that is being carried on during the after-death states—while the Human Life-Wave is carrying on its evolution on the present globe, Globe D—is being followed unconsciously. The state is similar to that which prevailed during the period when the human race was undergoing its development during the First and Second Races on this Fourth Round. That is to say, since the Manas-principle was not actively operating, Man was not consciously carrying on his evolution by means of self-directed efforts, therefore he

tan what te termed an unconscious state.

CHAPTER X

THE AFTER-DEATH STATES

has been established that Motion is eternal, irrespective of whether the ise is that of manifestation or non-manifestation. In a sense this is licable to the Monadic Essence—that part of man linked to immortality or its spheres of operation are not subject to finiteness. This forms one he keys to an understanding of the after-death states. Another key is tained in the Law of Periodicity: that periods of activity are followed periods of rest. These are two of the Divine Laws which encompass universe.

on the superior globes during the present Fourth Round, while the Human Host of Monads is carrying on its evolution on Globe D (in other words, functioning consciously while cycling on the Ascending Arc during the after-death states), such a one will have achieved the status of a Fifth-Rounder.

Then, carrying the theme to its logical conclusion, when a FifthRounder will learn how to perform the Outer Rounds consciously, he will be well on his way towards acting in the capacity of a Sixth-Rounder.

may be divided into two phases. (1) Ue aspect OF INC OM the after-death states. For that matter, a third phase may be

(3) the sleeping state, even though it includes the first two

wes. For in this state the vital bodily functions continue their operaus even though the “curtain of sleep has enwrapped the slumberer its folds. Then, associated with sleep is the state of dreaming (Svapna), tate of consciousness differing from that of the waking state (Jagrat). weover, there is a third state of consciousness known as Sushupti, the 1c of deep sleep. It is not akin either to the waking or the dreaming es. It is analagous to the after-death state of existence in that the death| part of man can function and be conscious on the planes superior to

world, However, since the personality is paralaysed, so to

y slumber, it is unable to register any messages from the deathless ‘tion of man. Instead of regarding the subject of death as though shrouded in

closed by a dark portal beyond which no one can peer, the